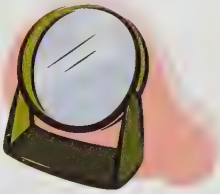


stores carry. They are the most affordable brand I've found, and they have a killer selection of scents.

My husband and I really enjoy having these homemade products on hand. Having several scents to choose from really makes us feel like we're living large and getting a custom product every time we make stuff for baths and massages. Even some of the more expensive scents like sandalwood last a really long time. So in the end, you are getting more spa, beauty, and bath products than you ever would otherwise. Which leaves you more money for other important bubble-bath necessities . . . like wine!

— Myscha Theriault



6 Ways to Get Your Toiletries for Cheap, or Even Free!

With my budget straining at the increase in the cost of milk, I can't always

justify buying my favorite shampoo, the best razor, or that luxurious body wash I crave. I have found ways to ease the pain, and while not always predictable, they work! If you don't mind getting a bit creative with your methods, you can pay much less (even nothing) for your bath and body treats, too!

1. Guest services

When I was a girl, my aunt came home from a convention in Vegas and dumped a gallon bag of designer minisoaps and tiny shampoo bottles into my lap. At the time, I thought she was loony. Who would use these hotel spiffs for everyday grooming? Years later, my husband began working a "road-warrior" job that left us with too many of the tiny treats. We continued to save them in a small plastic bucket in our bathroom closet. They came in handy when guests or relatives visited, and when the budget got a bit tight, we would hold off on buying full-size products until the bucket had been emptied. We could go weeks on what he had acquired in a year. (Before you complain that it's greedy to take the hotel soaps, if you don't use them, many places will throw them out anyway, as a hygienic measure.)

2. Free samples

Joke all you want about those of us who sign up for every free sample you